

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

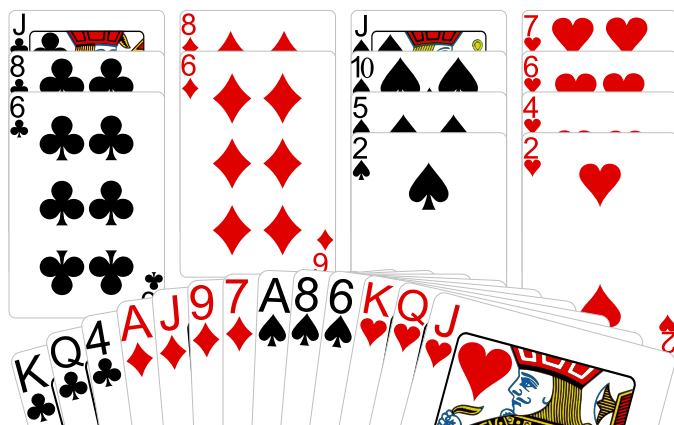
Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



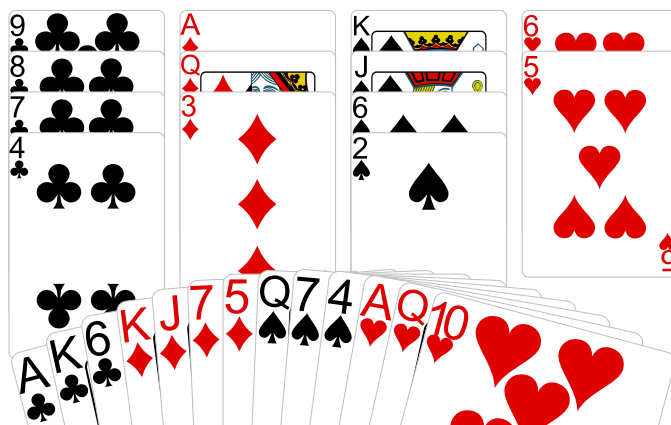
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



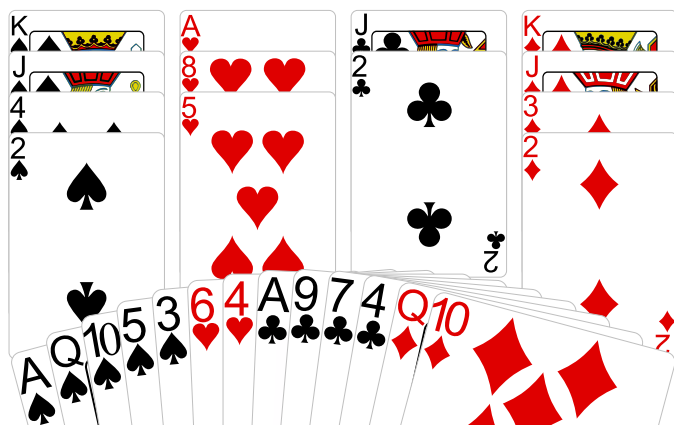
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



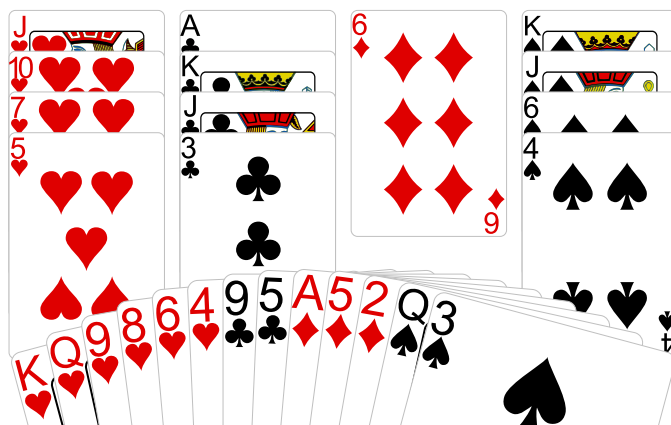
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 4
 ♥ 9 5 3
 ♦ K Q 2
 ♣ A T 7 2

♠ A 8 6
 ♥ K Q J
 ♦ A J 9 7
 ♣ K Q 4



♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A T 8
 ♦ T 5 4 3
 ♣ 9 5 3

♠ J T 5 2
 ♥ 7 6 4 2
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ J 8 6

NORTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming NORTH wants to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ 9 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 5 3 2



♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q T

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6

♠ T 9 3

♥ K J 8 4

♦ T 4 2

♣ Q J T

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

EAST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

WEST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2 ♠.

In theory EAST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 6
 ♥ K J T 9
 ♦ A 7 6 5
 ♣ T 8 5

♠ K J 4 2
 ♥ A 8 5
 ♦ K J 3 2
 ♣ J 2



♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 4
 ♣ K Q 6 3

♠ A Q T 5 3
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ Q T
 ♣ A 9 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points SOUTH should overcall 1 ♠.

NORTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If SOUTH had opened, NORTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since SOUTH overcalled, NORTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ K Q 9 8 6 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 9 5

♠ T 9 8 7
♥ 2
♦ Q T 9 7 4
♣ T 6 2



♠ K J 6 4
♥ J T 7 5
♦ 6
♣ A K J 3

♠ A 5 2
♥ A 3
♦ K J 8 3
♣ Q 8 7 4

EAST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦. But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

WEST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

EAST passes happily.

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Dbl	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			
4♥ by West			